

What is the score?

A score is the written version of a piece of music. In a full score, each instrument or voice involved has its own part written on an individual staff. Players perform their individual parts, which contain only their own line of music.

Orchestral score

Conductors use full scores for study, rehearsal, and performance. On the first page of the score, each part is labeled with the Italian name of the instrument. The instruments are grouped in families from top to bottom, with the highest-pitched instrument of each family first.

SEE ALSO

◀ 184–185 The orchestra

◀ 186–187 The conductor

Classical music

204–207 ▶

▽ Beethoven's *Symphony No. 2 in D major*

Scores provide a graphic representation of the sound. Beethoven's *Symphony No. 2* opens with all the instruments playing together (*tutti*), followed by wind and brass, and then the strings.

Speed → **Adagio molto** ♩ = 84 ← Metronome mark

Full orchestra plays the opening chords

Quiet answering phrase on double reeds

Quiet staccato woodwind

Slur

Sudden very loud chord

Ornamented violin passage

Pause

Very loud chords

Strings imitate woodwind phrase

Sudden very loud chords